



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: People Can Be So Inconsiderate!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about manners and customs.
- I can explain my opinion about past events in writing.
- I can express possibility or certainty.

Ask your partner:

- What would you say to someone who was never on time? Do you think it's rude?
- Can you think of some good manners that are bad manners in another country?





Let's Explore!

Peter is meeting his date at a sports bar. She doesn't have **the best record*** at being punctual ...

* "The best record" refers to her previous history.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Justin:** Fancy meeting you here!
- Peter:** Hi Justin. I haven't seen you for ages. How's the family?
- Justin:** Pam and the twins are great. They started primary school last month. We had thought they might not be ready but they are enjoying their new routine. What about you?
- Peter:** Actually, I'm waiting for my date to arrive ...
- Justin:** Still on the dating scene, eh? How long have you been waiting?
- Peter:** Half an hour. She must be trying to tell me something.
- Justin:** Oh don't say that. She might be stuck in traffic. It's a zoo after work.
- Peter:** Maybe ...
- Justin:** Or it may be the weather if she is using public transport. I heard that the subway is delayed due to water on the tracks at Bloom Station. How well do you know her?
- Peter:** This is only our second time out together. Come to think of it, she was an hour late for our first date too! We had tickets to a baseball game and missed the first five innings. The game had almost ended before she sauntered in.
- Justin:** Ouch! If I had waited for an hour and a half, there would not have been another date. And you still invited her out a second time?
- Peter:** I thought I might give her another chance. She's in the same field and highly ambitious. Plus, she's very attractive.
- Justin:** Well, I'm meeting up with friends for drinks and to watch the NFL playoffs on the big screen. You must join us!
- Peter:** Thanks buddy! I might sit here near the door for a bit. I'm starting to think that I'll be spending the evening with the guys. Pretty or not, making someone wait is just plain rude.
- Justin:** I'll shout you a drink ... WAITER.
- Peter:** Oh here she comes now. 45 minutes late? I wonder what the excuse will be this time.



Let's Practice!

Peter is unsure about the whereabouts of his date.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Write the sentences in the correct order. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. must / trying / something / She / . / me / to / tell / be /

2. She / . / might / stuck / in / traffic / be /

3. the / is / to / on / due / water / subway / The / . / tracks / delayed /

4. Oh, / her / might / . / be / this / now /

5. still / here / for / might / . / I / a / the / door / near / bit / sit



Let's Practice!

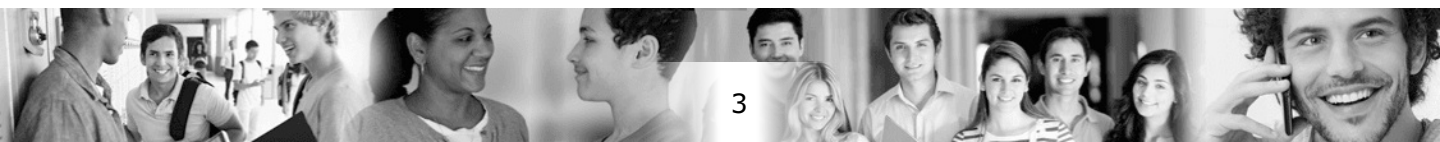
What happened? Peter and his friend talk about poor manners and behaviors.

Instructions: Use the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

1. If I had _____ for an hour and a half, there would _____ another date.
2. We _____ thought they might not be ready but they are enjoying their new _____.
3. The game had _____ before she _____ in.
4. I had _____ about leaving when my date _____.

Word Bank

not had been
almost ended
had
routine
thought
arrived
sauntered
waited





Extension Activity

Do you leave your shoes on or off when you enter a house? Let's write about customs or manners.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and compare the different manners and customs in two countries in different parts of the world.
- Research how people greet each other, eat, and communicate differently.
- Write brief notes on the similarities and differences.
- Use the notes to write a paragraph about the manners and customs in the two countries. Include a topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence.
For example: *There are significant cultural differences between the United States and China. In China it is impolite to leave your shoes on when you enter a house.*

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I go online and research the manners of two countries.

☐ ☐

I write brief notes from information I research online.

☐ ☐

I write a paragraph that talks about the differences between two countries.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to saunter** (verb): to walk along in a slow and relaxed manner
e.g. The game had almost ended before she sauntered in.
- dating scene** (noun): to visit different places when you are single
e.g. Are you still on the dating scene?
- it's a zoo** (expression): a wild, busy period
e.g. It's a zoo after work.
- track** (noun): iron rows that a train travels on
e.g. There was water flowing over the tracks.
- field** (noun): line of work
e.g. She is in the same field.
- big screen** (expression): a large television
e.g. Do you want to watch the game on the big screen?



Learning Points

Expressing an Opinion About Past Events

You use the Past Perfect tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:

Subject + had + past participle

*When I arrived at the party, Vanessa **had** already **gone** home.*

Which event happened *first*? Vanessa went home.

Which event happened *later*? I arrived at the party.

You use the Past Perfect tense (not Simple Past) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

Examples:

- *If I had waited for an hour and a half, there would not have been another date.*
- *We had thought they might not be ready but they are enjoying their new routine.*
- *I heard that the subway is delayed due to water on the tracks at Bloom Station.*

Modals for Possibility and Certainty

You use modals when you want to express possibility, certainty, suggestions and expectations.

You use *may*, *might* and *could* to express possibility in the past and in the future.

*Might suggests that something is less possible than may.

might / might not + infinitive could / could not + infinitive may / may not + infinitive

Expressing Certainty: You use **must** to express that something is necessarily true.

Examples:

- *She must be trying to tell me something.*
- *She might be stuck in traffic.*

